

Lecture 07

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Lecture 6 - A Brief review

- Hypotheses
- 1- and 2-sided T tests
- **Assumptions of parametric tests**
- What next



Lecture 7 overview

What we will cover today:

- What are the assumptions again and how do you assess them
- What to do when assumptions fail
 - Robust tests
 - Rank-based tests
 - Permutation tests

Lets work with the Lake Trout data as the weights are pretty cool and the assumptions may or may not hold

This is easily translated into any of the other dataframes you might want to use

lake trout



Setting Up Our Analysis

```
# Install packages if needed (uncomment if necessary)
# install.packages("readr")
```

```
# install.packages("tidyverse")
# install.packages("car")
# install.packages("here")

# Load libraries
library(car)           # For diagnostic tests
library(patchwork)
library(tidyverse)     # For data manipulation and visualization
```

Loading Lake Trout Data

```
# the stuff above controls the output and is also set at the top so dont need here
# Load the pine needle data
# Use here() function to specify the path
lt_df <- read_csv("data/lake_trout.csv")

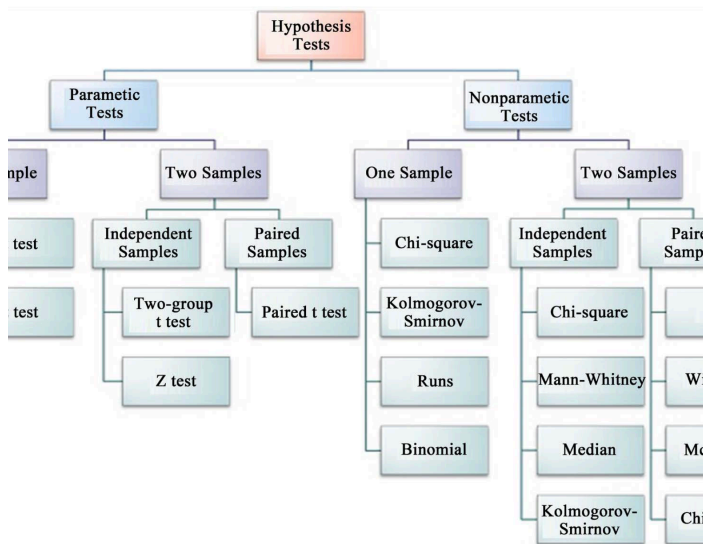
# Examine the first few rows
head(lt_df)
```

```
# A tibble: 6 × 5
  sampling_site species    length_mm mass_g lake
  <chr>         <chr>      <dbl>   <dbl> <chr>
1 I8          lake trout    515    1400 I8
2 I8          lake trout    468    1100 I8
3 I8          lake trout    527    1550 I8
4 I8          lake trout    525    1350 I8
5 I8          lake trout    517    1300 I8
6 I8          lake trout    607    2100 I8
```

Parametric versus non-parametric tests

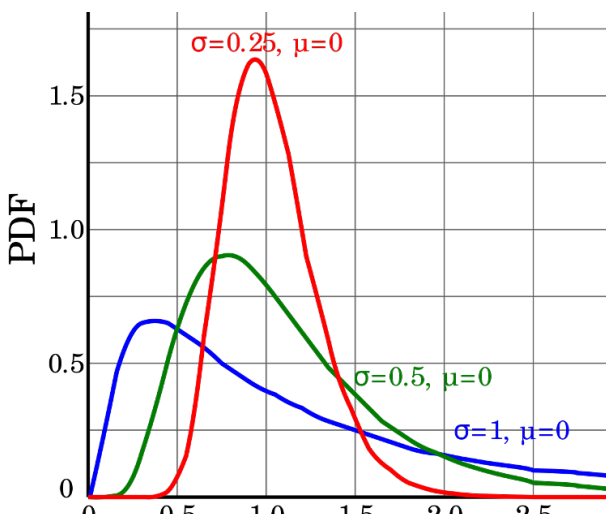
T-tests are **parametric** tests

- Parametric tests:
 - specify/assume probability distribution from which parameters came
 - Basic assumptions of parametric t-tests:
 - Random sampling
 - Normality
 - Equal variance
 - No outliers
- Non-parametric tests: no assumption about probability distribution
 - Mukasa et al 2021 DOI: 10.4236/ojbm.2021.93081



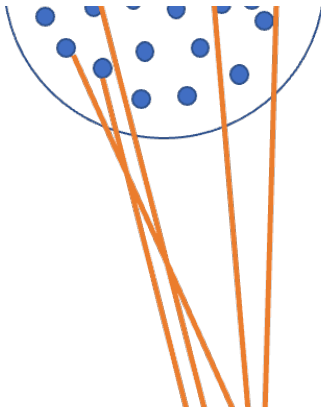
Assumptions of parametric tests - Overview

- If assumptions of parametric test violated, test becomes unreliable
- This is because test statistic may no longer follow distribution
- Most parametric tests robust to mild/moderate violations of below assumptions



Assumptions of parametric tests - Random Sampling

- Basic assumptions of parametric t-tests:
 - Random sampling
 - Normality
 - Equal variance
 - No outliers
- Random sampling:
 - samples are randomly collected from populations; part of experimental design
 - Necessary for sample -> population inference



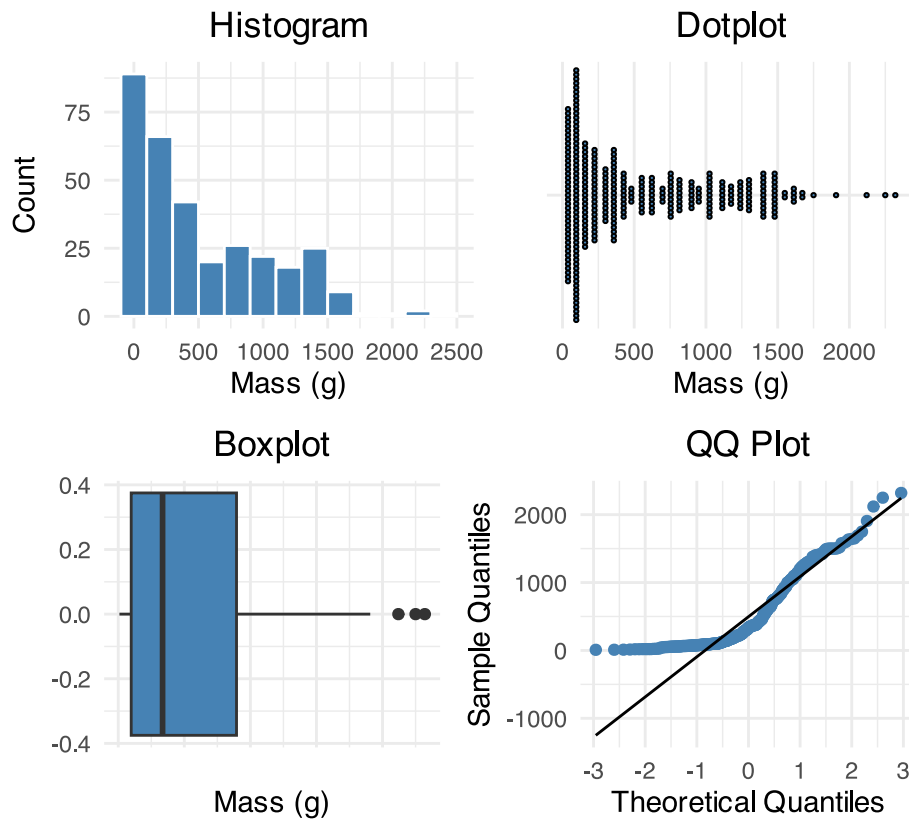
Assumptions of parametric tests - Normality Testing

Basic assumptions of parametric t-tests:

- Normality
- equal variance
- random sampling
- no outliers
- Lets do the above for one lake - NE 12 as if we were going to do a one sample T Test
 - we need to make a new dataframe with NE 12 data only called `ne12_data`
 - how do you do this?
- Normality: Samples from normally distributed population
 - Graphical tests: histograms, dotplots, boxplots, **qq-plots**
 - “Formal” tests: **Shapiro-Wilk test** - sometimes not useful

Lake NE 12 Trout Mass Distribution

n = 322 fish samples



Shapiro-Wilk Test for Normality

Basic assumptions of parametric t-tests:

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- equal variance
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 - we need to make a new dataframe with NE 12 data only called `ne12_data`
 - how do you do this?
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“Null hypothesis is that data is normally distributed”

```
[1] "Null hypothesis is that data is normally distributed"
```

Shapiro-Wilk normality test

```
data: ne12_data$length_mm  
W = 0.94528, p-value = 1.56e-09
```

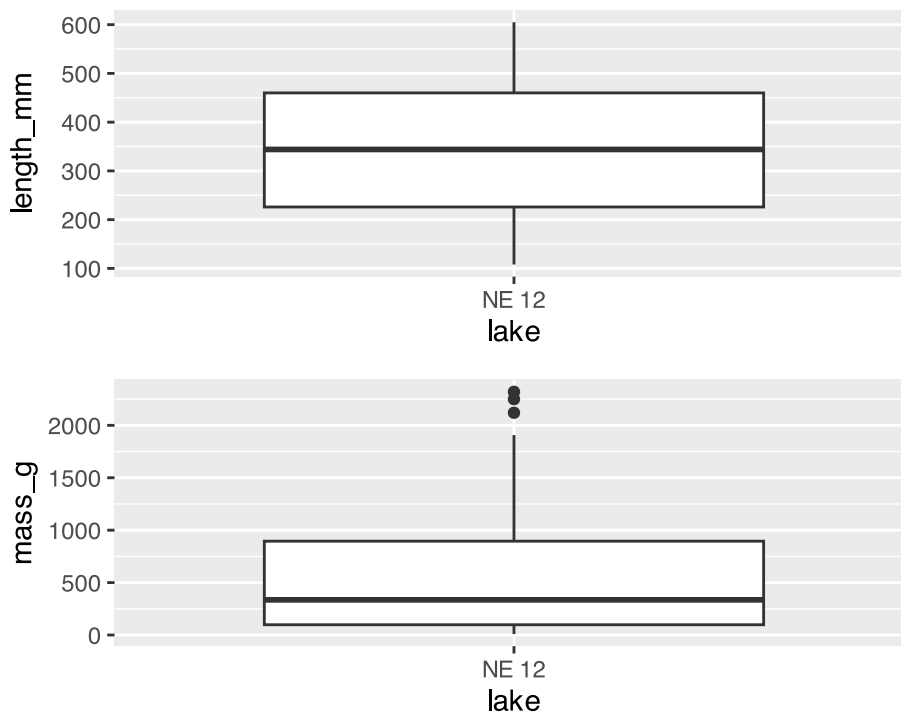
Testing Equal Variance Assumption

Basic assumptions of parametric t-tests:

- Normality
- equal variance
- random sampling
- no outliers

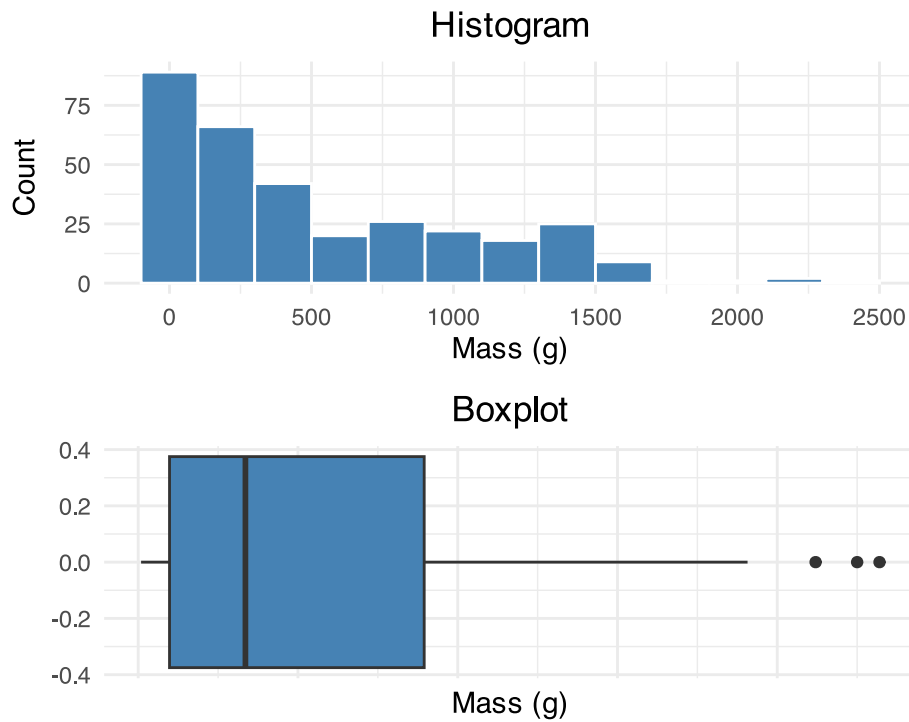
Equal variance: samples are from populations with similar degree of variability

- Graphical tests: boxplots
- “Formal” tests: F-ratio test
- When samples sizes equal
 - Parametric tests most robust to violations of normality
 - Less so for equal variation assumptions



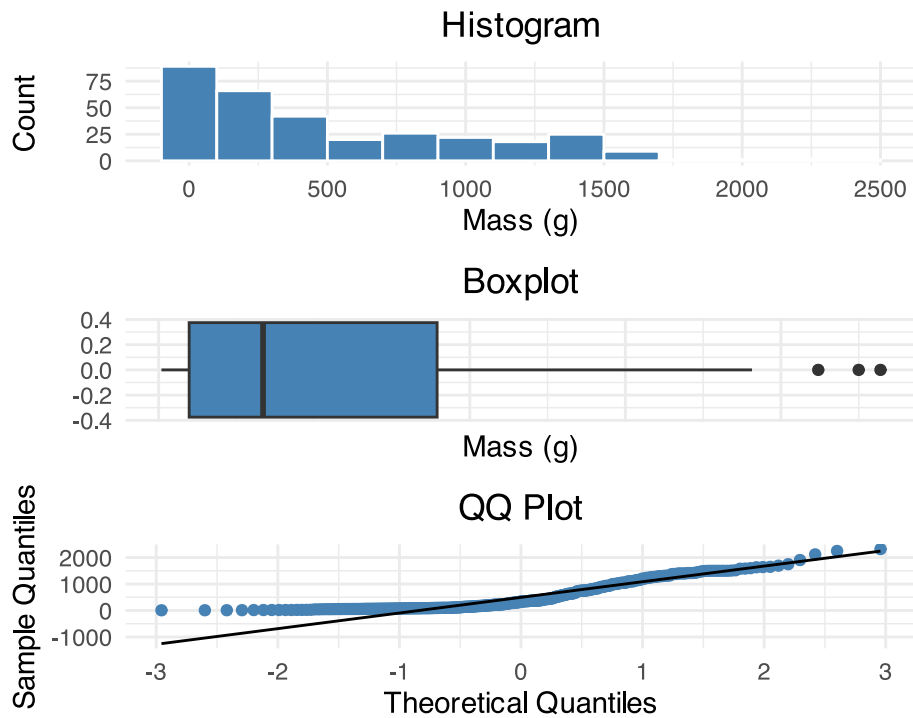
Testing for Outliers

- Basic assumptions of parametric t-tests:
 - Normality
 - equal variance
 - random sampling
 - no outliers
- No outliers: no “extreme” values that are very different from rest of sample
 - Graphical tests: boxplots, histograms
 - “Formal tests”: Grubb’s test - no one really does this
 - **Note: outliers a problem for non-parametric tests as well**



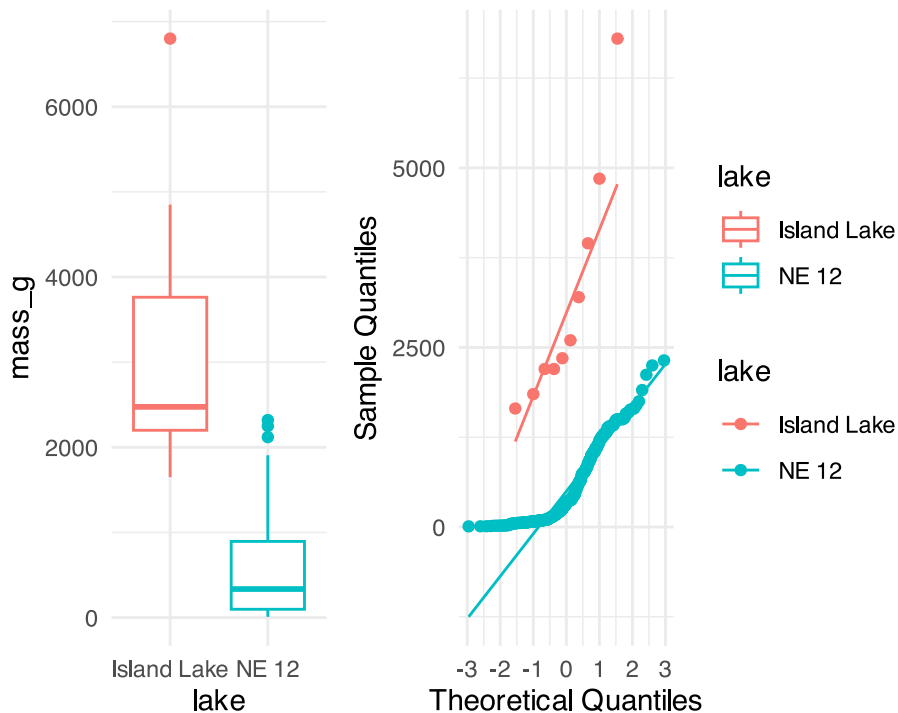
Alternative Tests When Assumptions Fail

- What if T Test assumptions fail?
- Alternative tests, with more relaxed assumptions, are available
- In which case would you use the following tests?
 - Welch's t-test: *when distribution normal but variance unequal*
 - Mann-Whitney-Wilcoxon test: *when distribution not normal and/or outliers are present (but both groups should still have similar distributions and ~equal variance)*
 - Permutation test for two samples: *when distribution not normal (but both groups should still have similar distributions and ~equal variance)*



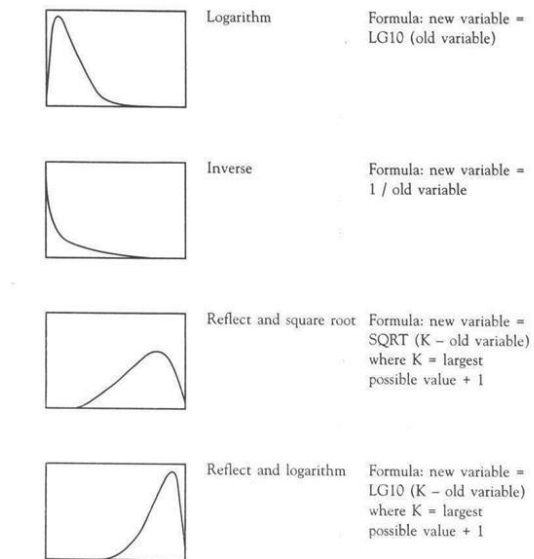
Understanding QQ-Plots

- QQ-plots: tool for assessing normality
 - ▶ On x- theoretical quantiles from SND
 - ▶ On y- ordered sample values
 - ▶ Deviation from normal can be detected as deviation from straight line



Data Transformations

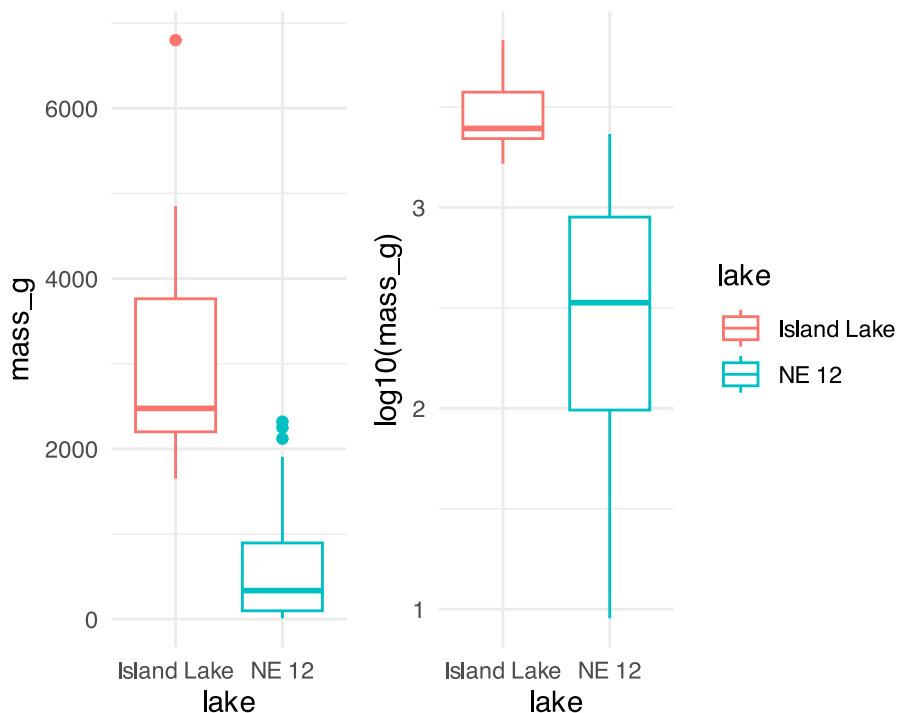
- In some cases, data can be mathematically “transformed” to meet assumptions of parametric tests
- this can be done in r and usually involves
 - log10 transformations
 - square root transformations
 - and many others... I will have a description soon



source

Robust tests - Welch's T-Test

- **Welch's t-test**
 - common “robust” test for means of two populations
 - Robust to violation of equal variance assumption, deals better with unequal sample size
 - Parametric test (assumes normal distribution)
 - Calculates a t statistic but recalculates df based on samples sizes and s



Comparing Standard T-Test vs Welch's T-Test

- Lets compare a parametric T-Test to a Welch's t-test
 - T-Test is:
 - `t.test(y1, y2, var.equal = TRUE, paired = FALSE)`
 - Welch's T-Test is:
 - `t.test(y1, y2, var.equal = FALSE, paired = FALSE)`

```
[1] "Standard t-test results for mass_g:"
```

Two Sample t-test

```
data: mass_g by lake
t = 14.181, df = 330, p-value < 2.2e-16
alternative hypothesis: true difference in means between group Island Lake and group NE 12 is
not equal to 0
95 percent confidence interval:
 2266.304 2996.360
sample estimates:
mean in group Island Lake      mean in group NE 12
          3165.0000              533.6677
```

```
[1] "Welch's t-test results for mass_g:"
```

Welch Two Sample t-test

```
data: mass_g by lake
t = 5.1368, df = 9.0578, p-value = 0.0006016
alternative hypothesis: true difference in means between group Island Lake and group NE 12 is
not equal to 0
95 percent confidence interval:
 1473.676 3788.989
sample estimates:
mean in group Island Lake      mean in group NE 12
          3165.0000              533.6677
```

Rank-Based Tests

Rank-based tests: no assumptions about distribution (non-parametric)

- Ranks of data: observations assigned ranks, sums (and signs for paired tests) of ranks for groups compared
- **Mann-Whitney U test** common alternative to independent samples t-test
- **Wilcoxon signed-rank** test is alternative to paired t-test
- Assumptions: similar distributions for groups, equal variance
- Less power than parametric tests
- Best when normality assumption can not be met by transformation (weird distribution) or large outliers

Mann-Whitney U Test Results

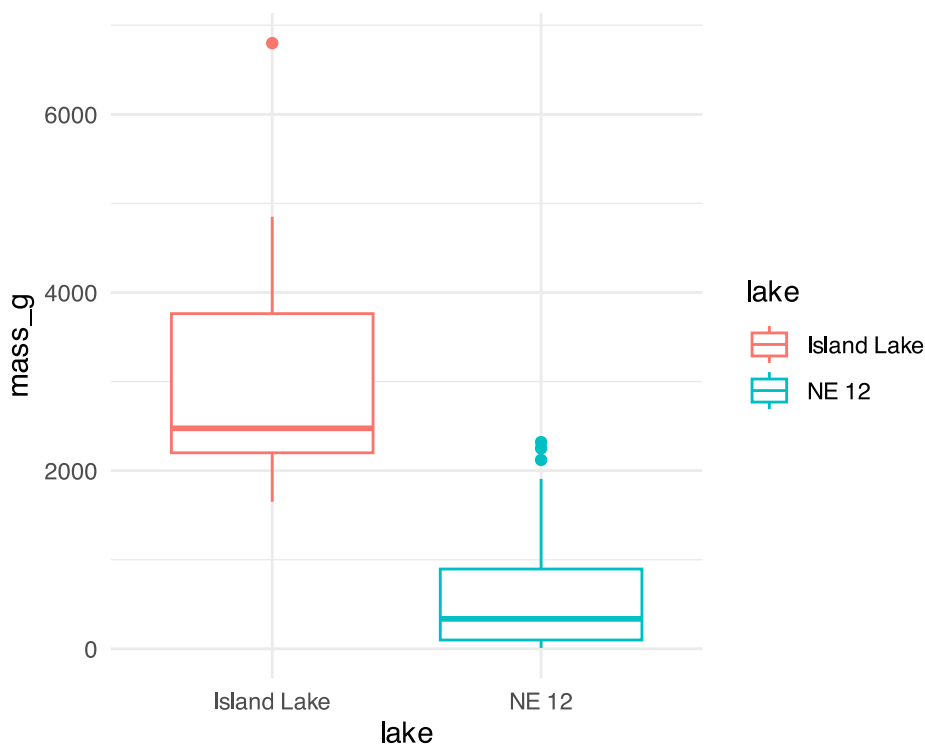
```
[1] "Mann-Whitney U test results mass_g:"
```

Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction

```
data: mass_g by lake  
W = 3205.5, p-value = 9.506e-08  
alternative hypothesis: true location shift is not equal to 0
```

Permutation Tests - Concept

- Permutation tests based on resampling: reshuffling of original data
- Resampling allows parameter estimation when distribution unknown, including SEs and CIs of statistics (means, medians)
- Common approach is bootstrap: resample sample with replacement many times, recalculate sample stats
- Use the `perm` package
- $H_0: \mu_A = \mu_B$
- $H_a: \mu_A \neq \mu_B$
- Calculates the difference Δ in means between two groups



Permutation Tests - Method

- Randomly reshuffle observations between groups (keeping $n_{NE\ 12} \approx 323$ and $n_{Island} = 10$), calculate Δ
- Repeat >1,000 times
- Record proportion of the different means i
- This is equivalent to p-value and can be used in “traditional” H test framework
- For a graphical explanation:

- Graphical Explanation

Permutation Test Implementation

- In R (using 'perm' package):
- Assumptions: both groups have similar distribution; equal variance

```
library(perm)

# Prepare data for permutation test
ne12_perm_data <- isl_ne12_df %>%
  filter(lake == "NE 12") %>%
  pull(length_mm)

# Randomly sample exactly 25 observations from NE 12 (set seed for reproducibility)
set.seed(123)
ne12_perm_data <- sample(ne12_perm_data, size = 25, replace = FALSE)

island_perm_data <- isl_ne12_df %>%
  filter(lake == "Island Lake") %>%
  pull(length_mm)

# Calculate the observed difference in means
observed_diff <- mean(ne12_perm_data, na.rm = TRUE) - mean(island_perm_data, na.rm = TRUE)

# Perform permutation test for difference in means using perm package
permTS(ne12_perm_data, island_perm_data,
        alternative = "two.sided",
        method = "exact.mc",
        control = permControl(nmc = 10000))
```

Exact Permutation Test Estimated by Monte Carlo

```
data:  GROUP 1 and GROUP 2
p-value = 2e-04
alternative hypothesis: true mean GROUP 1 - mean GROUP 2 is not equal to 0
sample estimates:
mean GROUP 1 - mean GROUP 2
               -333.08

p-value estimated from 10000 Monte Carlo replications
99 percent confidence interval on p-value:
0.0000000000 0.001059383
```

Summary - Testing Assumptions

Testing Assumptions of Parametric Tests

Key Assumptions

- **Random sampling:** Samples are randomly collected from populations
- **Normality:** Data follows a normal distribution
- **Equal variance:** Samples come from populations with similar variability
- **No outliers:** No extreme values that can skew results

Assessing Assumptions

- Key to do every time
- Should acknowledge in manuscript

Summary - Data Transformations

Data Transformations

When assumptions aren't met, transformations may help normalize data:

- **Log transformation:** $\log_{10}(x)$ - Useful for right-skewed data, multiplicative effects
- **Square root:** $\sqrt{x}$ - Useful for count data, moderately right-skewed distributions
- **Box-Cox:** More flexible family of power transformations
- **More specialized transformations** especially for percentages or proportions

Summary - Statistical Test Options

Statistical Test Options

1. Standard T-Test

Strengths: - High statistical power when assumptions are met - Well understood and widely accepted

Weaknesses: - Sensitive to violations of normality, equal variance - Heavily influenced by outliers

2. Welch's T-Test

Strengths: - Robust to violations of equal variance assumption - Handles unequal sample sizes well - Still parametric (assumes normality)

Weaknesses: - Slightly less powerful than standard t-test when variances are equal - Still assumes normal distribution

Summary - Non-Parametric Options

3. Mann-Whitney-Wilcoxon Test

Strengths: - Non-parametric: doesn't assume normal distribution - Robust against outliers - Works with ordinal data

Weaknesses: - Less statistical power than parametric tests - Still assumes similar distributions and approximate equal variance - Tests median differences rather than mean differences

4. Permutation Tests

Strengths: - Distribution-free: doesn't assume a specific distribution - Can be applied to many types of test statistics - Handles small sample sizes well - Directly estimates p-values through resampling

Weaknesses: - Computationally intensive - Assumes exchangeability under the null hypothesis - Requires similar distributions and equal variance

Key Takeaway

Statistical tests have different strengths and assumptions. The choice should be guided by your data characteristics, not just convenience. Always visualize your data before deciding on the appropriate test.